

Orite Music Cookie

The Orite Music Cookie packs the functionality of an MP3 player, voice recorder, FM radio and USB storage into one tiny oval-shaped glossy-red device. With a reasonably good set of features, jazzy looks and an affordable price tag, the Music Cookie can be considered as an option by youngsters. However, the FM radio performance and menu navigation need improvement, and should be considered before purchase.

Playback quality is average when headphones are used; Hindi tracks play reasonably well, but the player lacks bass. Voice recording quality is decent. The FM radio had problems catching signals even in



open areas. The 128 MB solid-state memory is sufficient for about 23 160 Kbps MP3 tracks at an average of 5 MB each. Transfer rates are fast, and battery life is quite good. Music Cookie can display lyrics inserted into the tracks using the 2.91 version of Winamp and Lyric121. But here's a bummer—you can't create playlists! You can create folders, but only MP3

tracks stored in the root can be played.

The voice-recording function uses the in-built microphone to capture audio in WAV format. The FM tuner can scan the entire frequency range, and you can store eight channels.

Downloading music on to the Cookie is simple. Plug into the USB port on your PC, and it's automatically recognised as a removable drive on Windows 2000, Me and XP. You can use Windows Explorer to manage files.

SPECIFICATIONS

128 MB flash memory, supports MP3 format, voice recording, FM radio, USB storage, 1.5 V AAA battery

Orite Music Cookie

A

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Features (Out of 50)

Orite Music Cookie	31
Creative LX100	34.5
Envyah DS601	33

Price: Rs 5,450

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Altec Lansing AHS-502 headset with microphone



The AHS-502 is a headset caters to the multimedia enthusiast. It comes in a gorgeous metallic and black colour combination with a cushioned headpad and closed-cup earpads.

First off, this is not an option for audiophiles—don't compare it with Sennheiser *et al.* But it's a good option for the general listener who wants good sound-quality with a microphone.

The closed cup earpad design helps in eliminating ambient noise to give you

clear and rich quality. The cushioned headpad is a welcome feature.

The headset remote control is attached to the main cord. It has sound and microphone controls.

We ran our usual battery of tests, connecting the AHS-502 to a P4 3 GHz system with an Audigy2 Platinum sound card. It did not disappoint.

The bass reproduction was nice, but at high volumes, it overpowered everything else, and sound quality suffered. Otherwise, the bass is thumpy and ambient, rather than just all

boom. Ideally, it could have been a little less prominent. Gamers though might like this kind of bass.

With Hindi songs, both classical and film songs were rendered faithfully without any distortion, and even at high volumes, the quality did not suffer.

The microphone is good quality, and showed good sensitivity.

SPECIFICATIONS

Frequency response: headphones—20 Hz~20 KHz; microphone—100 Hz~16 KHz, microphone sensitivity: -40 dB V/Pascal +/- 2 dB

Altec Lansing AHS-502

B+

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 1,600

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Fujitsu LBP 1120

Frequent fliers should find the Fujitsu LBP1120 a



great travel mate, especially if they are looking for an ultra-portable notebook with decent computing power.

Measuring just 1.4 x 9.1 x 6.3 inches, and weighing just 1.1 Kg, the LBP1120 is light and ultra-compact by any standards.

The LBP1120, as expected, performed below par on our tests. But the focus here is portability and not computing power. The battery dies after continuous usage for two and a half hours.

The LBP1120 is expensive. But if you can put up with the niggles, and just need a small notebook that fits in your suitcase, then this one fits the bill.

SPECIFICATIONS

Transmeta Crusoe TM5800 800 MHz CPU, 256 MB SDRAM, 30 GB hard drive, two USB 1.1 ports, one VGA port via adapter, 802.11b integrated adapter and one compact flash slot

Price: Rs 1,10,000

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Fujitsu LBP 1120

B-

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Usability	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶